Sarasota, Florida

In Florida, a very strong El Niño brings more than double the usual winter severe weather. The people it kills are asleep in manufactured homes at night, and the 1998 warning arrived eleven hours early. What they lacked was a door to go to. Nearly all of that exposure sits outside city limits.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Sarasota County, Florida (the Climate Impact Lab region containing the city)	No figure published for the US	Jun 2026 – Feb 2027 (heat only; not this hazard)	Night-time tornadoes in manufactured housing; heavy-rain flooding; power loss

18/18 recommendations verified. 7 corrected (partially confirmed), 0 confirmed outright, 5 unverified, 3 redundant, 3 contraindicated. The funding target moved from $760k to $670k, down 12%, under a third, so the envelope stands. **Scale caveat:** the City of Sarasota has 738 occupied mobile homes; Sarasota County has 13,535. About 95% of the exposure that drives this briefing lies outside city limits, so the mobile-home actions and funding are written at county scale. **Method caveat:** the session's web-search budget was exhausted; all agents worked by direct fetch, supplemented by the federal OpenFEMA and NOAA storm-events data. Unreachable: Sarasota County's own site, Florida Power & Light's medical programme pages, the state medical examiners' hurricane death reports, and retailer price pages. Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab, Sep 2026, pre-peer-review; it covers heat only and publishes no US figure. Nothing here is scaled from it.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



27.34°N 82.53°W, United States of America · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** A very strong El Niño brings more than double the usual winter severe weather, and it kills people asleep in manufactured homes: the 1998 warning came eleven hours early, but they had no door to go to.
- **First action.** Sarasota County Emergency Management, the School Board, park managers, and churches sign agreements by 15 November to open a named refuge for each manufactured-home and RV park on every tornado-watch night.*
- **The money.** $420k floor, $670k target, $1.17M ceiling; the floor buys 4,000 radios, 20 refuge agreements, and 4,000 CO alarms.
- **Do not.** Do not tell mobile-home residents to shelter in the bathroom: the Storm Prediction Center says get out.

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **This El Niño.** The US Climate Prediction Center's 10 September discussion gives a more than 90% chance of a very strong event and a 75% chance of a "historic" one for October–December 2026. It gives no timing yet for the return to neutral in 2027.
- **What very strong means here.** The National Weather Service office in Tampa Bay: "Very Strong El Niño events resulted in more than double the number of severe weather events (tornadoes, severe wind, and severe hail) compared to other ENSO categories," and 1997–98 had over three times as much. Rain is usually above average; temperatures slightly below normal, with freezes driven more by the Arctic Oscillation than by ENSO. The finding applies to *very strong* events only, which is what this one is forecast to be.
- **Who dies.** The 22–23 February 1998 Central Florida outbreak killed 42 people; 40 were in manufactured housing or RV parks, and seven tornadoes struck between about 11 pm and 2:30 am. The watch went out at 1:44 pm, about eleven hours before the deadliest tornado touched down at 12:40 am. The outbreak hit the I-4 corridor, not Sarasota.
- **What has hit Sarasota County.** NOAA's storm-events records: three tornadoes in the 1997–98 winter (an F0 at North Port on 23 January, an F1 near Venice and Casey Key at 4:26 am on 17 February, an F1 at 6:00 am at Tuttle Elementary in the city on 1 March); an EF2 on Siesta Key at 3:10 am on 17 January 2016, two injured. The same night an EF2 at Duette, in neighbouring Manatee County, destroyed a single-wide mobile home and killed two. The claim that Sarasota had tornadoes in the 1982–83 El Niño was checked and **refuted**: none on record from December 1982 to April 1983.
- **The people exposed.** Sarasota County: 13,535 occupied mobile homes (ACS 2019–23), plus about 8,400 held seasonally or vacant; 37.3% of residents are 65 or over; about 39,800 households are a person over 65 living alone. City of Sarasota: 738 occupied mobile homes; 29.3% over 65; about 5,030 seniors living alone. RVs are counted separately and are not included.
- **After the storm.** After Hurricane Irma, 16 of 129 deaths across three states were carbon monoxide and 17 were heat after power loss, 14 of them in one assisted-living facility. In Sarasota County, Hurricane Ian's two indirect deaths were a man of 94 and a woman of 80 whose oxygen machines lost power. Sarasota's emergency medical services logged carbon-monoxide poisoning, a generator explosion, and hypoxia in oxygen-dependent patients during Milton.*
- **The slow toll.** Young and Hsiang (Nature, 2024) estimate the average US hurricane causes 7,170 to 11,430 excess deaths over about fourteen years, against an average of 24 counted at the time; people over 65 carry 46%, and 13% of all Florida deaths from 1950 to 2015 trace to the state's hurricane climate. That is a state-level model. It supports the statement that Sarasota's older population is still inside a period of raised risk after Helene and Milton; it cannot be pinned to this county or to those storms.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the December–March severe-weather season. Five of seven lenses converged on the first action from different directions, and the convergence survives the shared-bias check because the evidence is a Florida event and federal guidance, not a borrowed study.

On every tornado-watch night, open a named, unlocked refuge for each manufactured-home and RV park in the county, and move residents before dark

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · HISTORIAN · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND FOR TORNADOES

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	TRIGGER
Sarasota County Emergency Management, School Board, park managers, churches	Agreements signed by 15 November	Staff time; ~20 site agreements (cost unsourced)	SPC tornado watch including Sarasota County

Federal guidance is unambiguous. The Storm Prediction Center tells mobile-home residents: "Get out! Even if your home is tied down, it is not as safe as an underground shelter or permanent, sturdy building." The National Weather Service says a mobile home is not safe shelter. The trigger has to be the **watch**, not the warning: warnings average about fifteen minutes of lead time, not enough to wake and drive at night, while the 1998 watch came eleven hours ahead. Schools and county buildings first, churches second, each with a named keyholder. Florida law requires none of this, so it has to be set up by agreement.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the "moderate risk" outlook is a weaker trigger than the watch and is dropped. The Florida statutes cited by one lens cover hurricane shelters, not mobile-home parks. Whether the county already designates tornado refuges could not be checked; its site blocked every fetch. The only evidence on use is a 2024 survey of about 1,450 people in which mobile-home residents reported more willingness to use public shelters than others; no study measures deaths prevented by watch-triggered moves. How many watch nights a very strong winter brings (a verifier's guess of three to eight) is unverified.

A warning that wakes people: alarm-capable weather radios in bedrooms, Alert Sarasota sign-ups at the door, and a neighbour who has agreed to knock

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · EMERGENCY MGR · PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC

ADAPTATION INVENTORY: PRECEDENT, US WINTER WEATHER ADVISORIES

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Red Cross, park associations, Newtown churches, volunteers	1 November for purchase; installation through December	~$55 per radio installed (Midland WR120 lists at $54.99)	Missing a 1 am warning while asleep

This is the layer that makes the first action work, not a substitute for it. A warning review found people "not confident about receiving tornado warning overnight, especially between 12 and 4 am": asleep, sirens inaudible indoors, no smartphone or weather radio. Night tornadoes are roughly twice as likely to be fatal. The same review reports one study finding no evidence that false alarms make the public complacent, so pre-season messaging is not harmful in itself. The Adaptation Inventory's closest precedent is US winter weather advisories, which reduced crashes and did more with longer lead times.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The Frontline lens's one thing stands: the only warning that reaches a sleeping person in a mobile home is a neighbour who already agreed to knock. Newtown's churches, the Robert L. Taylor Community Complex, and All Faiths Food Bank's pantry lines are the channels. Use allfaithsfoodbank.org on any material: the old address, allfaiths.org, now redirects to an unrelated organisation in New Mexico.

Close low-water crossings on Phillippi Creek, Whitaker Bayou, and low Newtown streets on a flood watch, not after the first rescue

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
City and County Public Works; Sheriff	1 November	Existing inventory	Vehicle drownings like Debby's in Phillippi Creek

The National Weather Service: "over half of all flood-related drownings occur when a vehicle is driven into hazardous flood water." Sarasota has its own case: during Debby in August 2024, when over 20 inches fell on the city, a 67-year-old man went missing and was found six days later in his submerged car in Phillippi Creek. Whether the city and county already close barricades on a watch could not be checked.*

Match the county's special-needs registry against the utility's medical list, and pre-assign a welfare check for every oxygen or dialysis user at four hours without power

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · EMERGENCY MGR · PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County Emergency Management; Florida Department of Health–Sarasota	1 December	Staff time	Deaths like Ian's two in Sarasota County

After Irma, three oxygen-dependent people and seventeen heat deaths followed power loss. Ian's two indirect deaths in Sarasota County were oxygen machines that stopped. A winter tornado outage is local and shorter than a hurricane's, which makes a targeted welfare check feasible. Florida Power & Light's medical-equipment programme pages returned errors, so what the utility promises those

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

customers could not be confirmed.*

Get renters and uninsured owners onto flood cover now, with contents-only policies for renters, and stop selling it as last-minute storm protection

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: PRECEDENT, US FLOOD DISCLOSURE (DAMAGE PROBABILITY −33%)

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Households; a foundation discretionary grant for low-income renters' premiums	As early as possible; cover starts 30 days after purchase	Premiums not verified	Losses that FEMA grants barely touch

The numbers make the case. In 2024 the National Flood Insurance Program paid $742.9M on Sarasota County claims (6,314 of 7,844 claims paid). After Milton, FEMA approved $51.8M for 15,562 homeowners, most of them $10,000 or less, and $11.1M across 21,779 renter registrations. Yet policies in force fell 4.6% in a year, from 41,791 to 39,868. Citizens Property Insurance holds 5,079 wind-only policies in the county, $2.46B of exposure with no flood cover attached. All four local communities hold a Class 5 rating, worth 25% off inside the high-risk zone and 10% outside.

Correction to the Economist's deadline: new policies wait 30 days (44 CFR 61.11(d)), and the map-change exception has lapsed for Sarasota. But El Niño's Florida risk runs December to March, so a policy bought after 15 October still covers most of the season. Earlier is better; 15 October is not a cliff.

Hand out battery carbon-monoxide alarms with generator placement guidance, through pantry lines and door to door

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · WEAK EVIDENCE | PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
All Faiths Food Bank partners; fire department	1 December	~$25 per alarm (price unverified)	Generator poisoning in the first days of an outage

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The pattern is confirmed: after Irma, 529 confirmed cases peaked within two days, 97.5% involved generators, and 31% had the generator inside the home, garage, or an attached structure. After the 2004 hurricanes, every fatal incident had the generator indoors, and another third of non-fatal incidents had it outdoors near a window. The weakness is the intervention: a six-month follow-up found alarms mostly working and well placed but batteries mostly not replaced, and no study measures poisonings averted by giving alarms away. Winter tornado outages are local, so this pool is smaller than after a hurricane. Placement guidance carries as much weight as the alarm.*

A mobile-home tie-down inspection sweep, starting with the oldest parks

UNVERIFIED · ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County building department	Before December for inspections; repairs slower	~$1,000 per home repaired (unsourced)	Homes lifted by weak tornadoes (EF0–EF1)

Florida law requires anchoring (s. 320.8325) but names no retrofit programme. My Safe Florida Home, the state's hardening grant, **excludes mobile and manufactured homes** and has no confirmed current funding. Whether a separate state tie-down programme exists could not be confirmed. Anchoring helps against weak tornadoes and does little against stronger ones, and it is no reason for anyone to stay inside on a watch night.

Track excess deaths among people over 65 this winter, not only storm-coded deaths

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · PUBLIC HEALTH · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Florida Department of Health–Sarasota	Baseline set before December	Analyst time	Missing the deaths certified as heart and lung disease

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The tornado count will be the headline; it will not be the toll. Deaths after displacement, disrupted care, and damp housing are certified as cardiac and respiratory. The national model makes the case for measuring; it does not give a Sarasota number.

Winter coastal-flood evacuation triggers for the barrier islands that do not depend on a named storm

UNVERIFIED | HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County Emergency Management	1 December	Staff time	A non-tropical surge caught without a plan

The precedent offered was the March 1993 Storm of the Century: 47 dead in Florida and surge up to 12 feet, but on the Big Bend coast, not Sarasota, and in an ENSO-neutral winter, not an El Niño. The Tampa Bay El Niño page does not mention coastal flooding. The hazard is plausible; the El Niño link is not shown.

Tie a red-tide respiratory alert to patients with COPD and asthma on the coast

UNVERIFIED | PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sarasota Memorial; Mote Marine Laboratory; Health Department	When a bloom is forecast	Low	Respiratory admissions during blooms

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Respiratory admissions at Sarasota Memorial rose 54% among residents within 1.6 km of the coast during the 2001 bloom, compared with 2002. The forecast model's 88% accuracy is inflated by easy "very low" days; it scores 61% on high-risk days and under 20% on low and moderate. A 2025 paper ties longer blooms to El Niño at a three-to-six month lag; only its abstract was read. No evaluation of a patient-targeted alert exists.

Plan fire breaks and prescribed burns for March–April 2027, for the dry turn after a wet winter

UNVERIFIED HISTORIAN ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Florida Forest Service; Myakka River State Park	Burns scheduled by February	Existing programmes	Fuel grown in the wet winter, plus 2024 storm debris, burning in spring

In 1998 the wet El Niño winter was followed by rain stopping in April, and about 500,000 acres and over 150 structures burned statewide from May to July, while El Niño collapsed into La Niña. The fires were in northeast and central counties; none is recorded in Sarasota or Myakka. The pattern is real; its reach here is not shown, and burn schedules could not be fetched.

A welcome desk and a one-page sheet for seasonal arrivals, in English, Spanish, and Haitian Creole

UNVERIFIED FRONTLINE ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Park and condo clubhouses; All Faiths pantry partners	November–December arrival weeks	Volunteer time; printing	Winter residents not knowing the local warnings

About 8,400 county mobile homes are seasonal or vacant, and 19.8% of the city's housing units were vacant in 2020, mostly seasonal. Those who arrive in November do not know where the refuge is. Which languages Alert Sarasota supports, and the size of the Haitian Creole-speaking community, could not be checked.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	County Emergency Management	School Board	Parks, clubhouses & churches	Red Cross Southwest Florida	All Faiths Food Bank & partners	City & County Public Works	Sheriff & fire department	FL Dept of Health–Sarasota	Florida Power & Light	Households	Community foundations	County building dept	Sarasota Memorial & Mote Marine	FL Forest Service & Myakka State Park
1. Watch-night refuges for mobile-home and RV parks	**A**	**R**	**R**								**C**			
2. Bedroom radios, alert sign-ups, neighbour knock			**R**	**A/R**	**R**						**C**			
3. Close low-water crossings on a flood watch						**A/R**	**R**							
4. Match registries; welfare checks for oxygen users	**A**							**R**	**C**					
5. Flood cover for renters and uninsured owners										**A/R**	**C**			
6. Battery CO alarms with generator guidance					**A/R**		**R**							
7. Mobile-home tie-down inspection sweep			**C**									**A/R**		
8. Track over-65 excess deaths this winter								**A/R**						
9. Barrier-island winter coastal-flood evacuation triggers	**A/R**													
10. Red-tide respiratory alert for COPD and asthma								**A**					**R**	
11. Fire breaks and prescribed burns for spring 2027														**A/R**
12. Welcome desk and sheet for seasonal arrivals			**A/R**		**R**									

What the chart shows. **County Emergency Management is accountable for the three rows that set triggers.** Those are rows 1, 4, and 9, and whether the county already designates tornado refuges could not be checked because its site blocked every fetch. **Volunteers carry the work that reaches people at night.** Rows 1, 2, and 12 rest on park associations, clubhouses, churches, and pantry partners, and Florida law requires none of it, so each refuge has to be set up by agreement. **Row 5 has no public owner.** Flood cover is bought household by household, and a foundation discretionary grant can help only low-income renters with premiums, because both foundations' disaster funds pay for recovery, not preparation. **Five rows are unverified.** Rows 7, 9, 10, 11, and 12 have owners, but the report could not confirm the case for acting on them.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled and verified. Roofs and tarps are excluded: Sarasota County's $210M federal recovery allocation for Milton covers rebuilding. The deaths this winter happen at night, in mobile homes, and the money that prevents them is small.

FLOOR	TARGET	CEILING	LARGEST UNCERTAINTY
$420k	**$670k**	**$1.17M**	**Whether a state programme already funds tie-downs**

Arithmetic. Floor: 4,000 radios × $55 = $220k, plus 20 refuge agreements $100k, plus 4,000 CO alarms × $25 = $100k, total $420k. Target: floor plus 250 tie-down repairs × $1,000 = $670k. Ceiling: target plus 500 more tie-downs = $1.17M, past which money cannot be installed before January. The lens proposed $760k; the target is down 12%, under a third, so the envelope stands. The lens's $150k for cold-night beds was dropped as redundant: the Salvation Army already opens 30 cold-weather beds below 42 °F, and its January 2026 peak was 22 people. Sizing: 4,000 radios reach about 30% of the county's 13,535 occupied mobile homes. **Routing correction:** both community foundations' disaster funds pay for recovery after a storm, not preparation before one, so these placements go through the foundations' discretionary grants or direct to the Red Cross.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
County Emergency Management with the School Board and churches	Action 1: 20 watch-night refuge agreements with keyholders	$100k	Discretionary grant (Gulf Coast Community Foundation)	$5,000 per site is unsourced. No outcome evidence exists; ranked first on federal guidance and the 1998 record.	Keep, re-routed
Red Cross Southwest Florida and park associations	Action 2: 4,000 alarm-capable weather radios, installed in bedrooms	$220k	Discretionary grant (Community Foundation of Sarasota County) or direct	Price corrected to $55 from the lens's $40. No cost-effectiveness study found. The warning layer for action 1, not a substitute.	Keep, price corrected
All Faiths Food Bank and partners	Action 6: 4,000 CO alarms with placement guidance	$100k	Pre-positioned stock	All Faiths delivered 293,000 meals after Helene and Milton. Alarm price and effect unverified; lower confidence.	Keep, lower confidence

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
County building department or a park-owners' association	Action 7: 250 to 750 tie-down repairs	$250k–$750k	Direct grant	Unit cost unsourced; possible duplicate of a state programme; helps only against weak tornadoes.	Ceiling only, hold
Salvation Army of Sarasota County	Cold-night beds	$0	—	Already running: 30 beds below 42 °F, peak 22 in January 2026.	Redundant

The funder's one thing survives: $210M of federal money is in Sarasota for rebuilding houses, and the deaths this winter will be people asleep in mobile homes who never reached a sturdy building. Under $1M in keyholders, radios, and alarms, spent before December, buys more lives than another roof. One verified caveat for any funder thinking of a triggered release: no US community foundation precedent for pre-agreed, trigger-released grants could be found; the Suncoast Disaster Recovery Fund activates at its own discretion.

DO NOT DO THIS — CONTRAINDICATED

Advice that circulates for tornadoes and storms and would cost lives here.

Do not tell mobile-home residents to shelter in the bathroom

CONTRAINDICATED SKEPTIC; CONFIRMED ON FEDERAL GUIDANCE

The small interior room is the advice for a house. For a mobile home, the Storm Prediction Center says get out, even if the home is tied down. In 1998, 40 of 42 deaths were in manufactured housing.

Instead: leave for the named refuge when the watch is issued, before dark.

Do not rely on sirens or phone alerts as the night-time warning

CONTRAINDICATED SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE; CONFIRMED

Sirens are generally hard to hear indoors. People are least confident of receiving a warning between midnight and 4 am, when phones are silenced and everyone is asleep, which is when the 1998 tornadoes struck.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: an alarm-capable weather radio in the bedroom and a neighbour who has agreed to knock, on top of the watch-night move.

Do not hand out generators after an outage without CO alarms and placement guidance*

CONTRAINDICATED SKEPTIC · PUBLIC HEALTH; CONFIRMED

Carbon monoxide was the largest accidental cause of death after Irma. Every fatal generator incident after the 2004 hurricanes had the unit indoors, and a third of non-fatal ones had it outdoors but near a window. Sarasota's own paramedics logged generator poisoning and burns during Milton.

Instead: an alarm and hands-on placement advice with every unit, and restored power prioritised for oxygen and dialysis users.

DROPPED AS REDUNDANT — ALREADY IN PLACE

- **Clear Phillippi Creek before November.** Already under way: a $41M county dredging project covering about seven miles, permitted in October 2025; phase one finished in May 2026 on 1.7 miles; phase two permits are expected by the end of 2026 and completion by the end of 2027. The useful ask is to speed phase two.
- **Open cold-night shelter beds.** The Salvation Army already opens 30 cold-weather beds when the temperature or feels-like drops below 42 °F, and churches added space in the January 2026 cold snap. No cold-exposure deaths among unhoused people in Sarasota could be found.
- **Fund roofs and tarps.** Covered by $210M of federal recovery money for Milton, and by My Safe Florida Home for site-built homes when funded.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

DATE	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1982–83	Strong El Niño; peninsula tornado activity up	No Sarasota County tornado on record	—
Mar 1993	Storm of the Century (ENSO-neutral); surge up to 12 ft on the Big Bend	47 dead in Florida	Not an El Niño precedent

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

DATE	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Jan–Mar 1998	Very strong El Niño; three tornadoes in Sarasota County, one at Tuttle Elementary at 6 am	—	—
22–23 Feb 1998	Central Florida outbreak on the I-4 corridor; watch 11 hours ahead	42 dead, 40 in manufactured housing or RVs	—
May–Jul 1998	Statewide wildfires as El Niño collapsed	~500,000 acres, 150+ structures	None recorded in Sarasota
17 Jan 2016	Very strong El Niño; EF2 on Siesta Key at 3:10 am; EF2 at Duette, Manatee County	2 injured on Siesta; 2 dead in a mobile home at Duette	—
Sep 2022	Hurricane Ian; Myakka River record 12.55 ft	10 direct and 2 indirect deaths in the county, both oxygen machines	—
Aug 2024	Debby: over 20 inches on the city	1 dead in a submerged car in Phillippi Creek	Creek dredging permitted 2025
Oct 2024	Milton landfall at Siesta Key, 9 Oct; over 8 ft of water nearby; 46 tornadoes statewide	County toll not verified; tornado deaths were in St. Lucie	$210M federal recovery allocation
2024–26	Flood policies in force fall 4.6% after $742.9M in 2024 claims	—	Fewer insured, not more
Jan 2026	Cold snap; lows in the low 30s	Cold shelter peak 22 of 30 beds	—
10 Sep 2026	CPC: over 90% chance of a very strong El Niño	—	This briefing

The recurrence nobody has noticed, from the Historian and corrected by the storm records: in both of the last two very strong El Niños, tornadoes struck Sarasota County in the dark, between 3 and 6 am. The storms that killed nobody here did so by luck of where they touched

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

down. The housing is the hazard; the storm type only decides the night.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **More warnings** versus **a place to go**. The Philanthropist ranked radios first; the Skeptic said 1998's victims were warned and died because where they slept could not survive. Resolved: the refuge ranks first and the radio is its alerting layer. Neither has outcome evidence.
- **The 15 October flood-insurance deadline** versus **the season's timing**. The Economist called it a cliff; the verifier found the risk runs December to March, so a later purchase still covers most of it. Earlier is still better.
- **City** versus **county**. The request named the city; the exposure is in the county. Every mobile-home figure here is county-scale, and the city's own share (738 homes) is small.
- **Fire in spring 2027.** The Historian's warning rests on 1998, when the fires were statewide but not recorded here. CPC gives no timing yet for the end of this El Niño. What would settle it: the Florida Forest Service's drought index for Sarasota in February.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

No lens counted the RV parks, which the census excludes and where Ponderosa lost nearly all of its 200 units in 1998. No lens asked about assisted-living and nursing facilities, where 14 people died after Irma when the power failed; a facility generator check belongs beside the registry action. No lens looked at workers who sleep in vehicles or at job sites. And no lens could reach the county's own emergency plan, so whether any of the first three actions already exist in some form is the question to put to Sarasota County Emergency Management first.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

Each briefing starts from a single, precise place, such as a village, a ward, or a district, because that is the scale at which useful actions differ. We first work out what can honestly be measured there. That usually means the Climate Impact Lab's published figures where they exist, the local rainfall record, census data, and the history of what has actually gone wrong in that place. Where no reliable number exists, we say so plainly rather than stretch a regional figure to fit.

We then put the same question to seven expert perspectives, each run as a separate AI research agent working from real sources. Each one asks what people here can do before the peak to keep each other alive.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **The Emergency Manager** looks at what failed operationally in past events.
- **The Public Health Scientist** looks at who is most at risk and which interventions have measured effects.
- **The Frontline Responder** looks at how the community actually works and who people trust.
- **The Skeptic** looks for advice that has backfired in comparable places.
- **The Economist** asks who pays, who carries the risk uninsured, and whether any money is pre-arranged to arrive on a trigger.
- **The Historian** looks for the pattern that keeps repeating.
- **The Philanthropist** asks where a grant would do the most good, and how much money the place could realistically absorb before the peak.

The seven briefs are then reconciled. Agreement between lenses counts for less than it appears to, because they often draw on the same famous studies. Where one lens recommends something another calls harmful, both sides are recorded rather than quietly resolved. Every surviving action needs an owner, a date, a cost, and a named payer, or it is marked unfunded. The funding recommendation becomes a bounded range: a floor, a target, and a ceiling, each with its arithmetic shown. Finally, a separate set of agents checks every recommendation against primary sources. They test whether the evidence is real, whether it came from somewhere like this place, and whether the action can be done here in time. Anything found to be harmful is kept in the report under its own heading, because advice that would cost lives is the most important thing a reader can be warned about. The result is a strong, source-checked hypothesis from a simulated panel, not a consensus of the field, and each briefing says so.

This run. The session's web-search budget was exhausted, so all thirteen agents worked by direct fetch, strengthened here by federal data: OpenFEMA for insurance and assistance, NOAA's storm-events files for local tornadoes, and the census for housing. The unverified count reflects pages that were blocked, not claims that were refuted. Six verifiers checked eighteen recommendations; the verdict tags carry the result.

The El Niño projection covers *heat only* and publishes nothing for the US; tornadoes, flooding, and power loss are carried here by the record. The Adaptation Inventory was consulted through its data feed (96 entries, 30 countries): the US is well represented on flood maps, disclosure, and forecasts, but nothing covers tornadoes, mobile homes, safe rooms, carbon monoxide, or cold shelters.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED

METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The location was taken as given: Sarasota, Florida. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as the report records it: Sarasota County, Florida (the Climate Impact Lab region containing the city). Mortality figures exist only at that scale (impact regions average roughly 300,000

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

people); sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.

- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Where heat is not the dominant hazard, the historical record carries the hazard instead of a borrowed number.
- **Expert panel.** Seven simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, and philanthropist) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Separate verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Consulted; the closest documented precedent for each action, or its absence, is shown in that action's tags.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (tornado shelter, driving into floodwater, oxygen and dialysis in an outage, generators, and carbon monoxide) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. Gaps specific to this run are recorded in the verification banner and in each action's tags.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

References (verification status in brackets) · NWS Tampa Bay, El Niño winters weather.gov [confirmed, very strong events only] · CPC ENSO discussion cpc.ncep.noaa.gov · ONI table cpc.ncep.noaa.gov [confirmed] · 1998 outbreak wikipedia · NOAA storm events ncei.noaa.gov · Tornadoes of 2016 wikipedia [confirmed; 1983 claim refuted] · SPC tornado FAQ spc.noaa.gov · NWS during a tornado weather.gov · Ready.gov ready.gov · warning review PMC10098234 · nocturnal tornadoes wikipedia · shelter-use survey, Croskery and Sherman-Morris 2024 PMID 39776363 [confirmed] · Fla. Stat. 252.385 leg.state.fl.us · Fla. Stat. 320.8325 flsenate.gov · Census housing and age, ACS data.census.gov · censusreporter.org [confirmed] · Irma deaths, Issa 2018 PMC6072056 · Irma CO, Mulay 2019 PMC6606217 · 2004 CO cdc.gov · Milton EMS, Nackley 2025 europepmc.org · Ian in Florida wikipedia [confirmed with corrections] · Excess mortality, Young and Hsiang 2024 PMC11541193 [confirmed; state-level] · red tide, Kirkpatrick 2006 PMC2847280 · red-tide forecast PMC13062942 · Turn Around Don't Drown weather.gov · Debby wikipedia · Milton wikipedia · Milton tornadoes wikipedia · 1993 storm wikipedia · 1998 wildfires wikipedia · Phillippi Creek dredging wusf.org · cold shelter wusf.org [confirmed] · NFIP claims and policies OpenFEMA · FEMA assistance OpenFEMA · Community Rating System OpenFEMA · 30-day wait ecfr.gov · Citizens citizensfla.com · My Safe Florida Home mysafeflhome.com · CDBG-DR allocation federalregister.gov [confirmed] · Suncoast Disaster Recovery Fund cfsarasota.org · Gulf Coast Community Foundation gulfcoastcf.org · All Faiths Food Bank allfaithsfoodbank.org · Midland weather radio midlandusa.com · CDC carbon monoxide cdc.gov · Newtown wikipedia · Unreachable or unconfirmed this run: Sarasota County's emergency plan and any existing tornado refuges; FPL medical programme terms; Milton's Sarasota County death count; alarm, tie-down, and agreement costs; any state mobile-home tie-down programme; Alert Sarasota languages; prescribed-burn schedules.
Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory (queried via wp-json/wp/v2/interventions; US winter weather advisories entry; US flood disclosure entry)
Generated 26 September 2026 for Sarasota, Florida. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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